

This template should be used by Cooperating Technical Partners (CTPs) who are submitting an application for an award to complete Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies (COMS) activities.



FEMA

Illinois State Water Survey
COOPERATING TECHNICAL PARTNERS (CTP)
COMMUNITY OUTREACH AND MITIGATION STRATEGIES
(COMS)
STATEMENT OF WORK (SOW)

COMS SOW No. ISWS 21-11 COMS SOW

In accordance with the CTP Partnership Agreement referenced in Table 1.1 between **Illinois State Water Survey** (herein referred to as “CTP”) and the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA), the following explains the scope to be undertaken by **Illinois State Water Survey** to enhance communication and coordination detailed within this Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies (COMS) Statement of Work (SOW) No. **ISWS 21-11COMS** as follows:

DOCUMENT ORGANIZATION

This document is organized into Part 1 and Part 2 to simplify and streamline the Statement of Work (SOW) completion process and improve the usability of the SOW for both the Cooperating Technical Partner (CTP) and Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA). **Part 1 will be completed by each CTP.** The CTP will provide a narrative on the project and complete a series of tables to demonstrate the work to be completed under this SOW, the schedule for delivery, leverage, budget performance measures, and more.

Part 2 of this document provides standard, detailed reference information regarding fundable activities and scope items, Standards, use of contractors, and more that are relevant to the Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategy (COMS) SOW. **Part 2 does not require any inputs from the CTP – it simply acts as standard language for this COMS SOW that the CTP can review and reference as needed.**

DISCLAIMER (DO NOT DELETE): In recognition of the MIP Studies Redesign which was deployed in June 2017, FEMA Region V has made an effort to update the accompanying **RV MIP Workbook** to align with terminology, projects, purchases and tasks in the redesigned MIP. The Region acknowledges that the signed MAS or SOW may or may not contain the required sections, tables, scope or terminology that is fully aligned with the **RV MIP Workbook**. Due to these reasons, the **RV MIP Workbook** will be

treated as the sole source for creating and obligating projects, purchases and tasks in the redesigned MIP, and must be completed by the CTP.

PART 1 – CUSTOM STATEMENT OF WORK (SOW) INFORMATION

1.1 – Project and Point of Contact Information

Instructions: Complete Table 1.1 below with the basic project information and point of contact information for both the CTP and FEMA staff.

Table 1.1: Insert Project and Point of Contact Information

Information Type	Insert Information
CTP Organization Name:	Illinois State Water Survey
CTP Contractor Working on the activities in this SOW (<i>optional, only if contractors have already been identified; contractor support may be used for all activities except Staffing and Mentoring, which must be completed by the CTP</i>).	NA
CTP Partnership Agreement Date:	September 9, 2013
Period of Performance:	09/01/2021 to 09/30/2023
CTP Project Manager:	Glenn Heistand
FEMA Regional Project Officer: <i>When necessary, additional FEMA assistance should be requested through the FEMA Regional Project Officer.</i>	John Wethington 5
FEMA Funding to Complete this COMS SOW:	\$125,000
CTP Estimated Leverage (<i>Final Leverage dollars or units will be entered as applicable in the Manage Data Development Task Workflow. Leverage data shown here is an estimate of available Leverage at the time the scope is prepared and may be refined throughout the project.</i>)	NA

Project Coordination Activities: <i>Throughout the project, all members of the Project Team will coordinate, as needed, to ensure that activities, products, and deliverables meet FEMA requirements and contain accurate, up-to-date information.</i>	• Meetings, teleconferences, and video conferences with FEMA and other Project Team members Monthly • Telephone conversations with FEMA and other Project Team members on a scheduled Monthly basis and ad hoc basis, as required • Email as needed
--	---

1.2 – Identify Tasks and Deliverables to be Completed Under this SOW

CTP must indicate deliverable and leverage details below for activities that are applicable. CTP will also use the RV MIP Workbook to indicate associated MIP task, grant, cost and schedule details.

Instructions: Tasks and deliverables that can be accomplished under this COMS SOW are in the table below. Please fill out the table below by checking the box of the activities and deliverables to be completed and add a description of the detailed scope elements for each relevant task. Please also add funding/project budget information per task. FEMA is providing funding to the CTP for the completion of this COMS SOW (funding column A). The CTP shall provide any additional resources required to complete the assigned activities for this COMS SOW (also known as Leverage, column B). The Leverage listed below is based on Blue Book values or actual costs where Blue Book values do not exist. The current Blue Book is dated April 2017 and can be downloaded from FEMA’s Information Resource Library at https://www.fema.gov/sites/default/files/documents/fema_risk-map_blue-book_2017.pdf.

Table 1.2.1: Identify COMS SOW Activities and Deliverables to be Completed

COMS Task	Mark “X” if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark “X” if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
COMS Engagement Plan (required) <i>Insert language in the “Detailed Scope Elements” field below if this is a joint plan with the PM SOW task.</i>	☒	COMS Engagement Plan (required)	☒	\$20,000		\$20,000
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements: A stand-alone COMS Engagement Plan will be drafted within 6 months of award of this grant. The COMS Engagement plan will be integrated into the joint Business Plan developed by ISWS & Illinois Department of Natural Resources in a future funding year. The COMS Engagement Plan will document the capabilities, accomplishments and outline the comprehensive outreach plan related to Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies. ISWS’s vision for implementing or participating in Risk MAP, specifically describing how ISWS’s activities advance the vision, goals and objectives of Risk MAP for encouraging communities to take action to mitigate risk. The COMS Engagement Plan will also include recommendations to FEMA regarding action and outreach potential for future Risk MAP projects within the State.						
Strategic Planning for Community Engagement	☒	Awareness and Action Strategy	☐	\$25,000		\$25,000
		Watershed and community assessment and mitigation action plan for prioritized communities	☐			
		Integrated and strategic plan for advancing relationships with partners and community stakeholders	☐			

COMS Task	Mark “X” if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark “X” if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
		Summary of activities that will increase flood risk awareness and subsequent or related mitigation actions	☐			
		New or updated community profiles that reflect insights gained from community research	☐			
		Prioritized list of communities, their potential for action readiness within a watershed based on action potential or action readiness, contribution to the action target, and detailed outreach and coordination activities that helped them in this undertaking	☐			
		Summary of outcomes/next steps from partnership coordination.	☐			
		Update to CTP’s website and other digital platforms as needed	☒			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
		Detailed Scope Elements: Updating and maintain a digital presence is critical to convey information to stakeholders and to keep all partners at the State, Federal and local levels informed of current floodplain mapping, engineering, and mitigation efforts. Scope includes: adding content to website to describe status of current work conducted by ISWS in Illinois for FEMA, add upcoming meetings and trainings to appropriate pages, add descriptive information and a link to the Structures at Flood Risk (SAFR) site that contains depth and analysis grids and flood risk assessment data, remove outdated contacts and content, reorganize content, add content and resources developed by ISWS and FEMA related to mitigation planning, redesign website theme and menus.				
Meetings and Process Facilitation	☐	Key influencers list	☐			
		Key Influencer Relationship Management Plan	☐			
		Meeting minutes, attendees list, and actions discussed/identified (provided to FEMA Region within 2 weeks of the meeting).	☐			
		Report on Awareness Post-Meeting Survey results as a result of the Discovery, Flood Risk	☐			

COMS Task	Mark "X" if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark "X" if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
		Review, CCO, and Resilience Meetings, if applicable. (Note: this could include polling data from virtual meetings)				
		Other: {Insert additional details} .	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Mitigation Support	☐	Action Identification and Advancement Strategy (i.e., a summary of the partners' approach to encourage community uptake in mitigation)	☐			
		Quarterly projections indicating the potential collection of Actions Identified and Advanced;	☐			
		Summary of new Actions Advanced or status updates on existing Actions Advanced through this coordination.	☐			
		Other: {Insert additional details} .	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Communication and Outreach to Communities	☐	Newly developed messaging and outreach materials that frame flood risk in an accessible way for communities	☐			
		Newly developed outreach materials that help community officials to outreach to their	☐			

COMS Task	Mark “X” if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark “X” if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
		constituents to inform them of flood risk and ways to reduce their risk.				
		Report on outreach activities	☐			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Training and Community Capability Development	☒	Copies of draft and final training materials	☒	\$55,000		\$55,000
		A list of training instructors	☒			
		A list of all participants and completed course evaluations (such as pre- and post-knowledge surveys) after each training course	☒			
		Report on outreach activities, if applicable	☐			
		A description of how training will benefit the public and accomplish the Risk MAP goals of awareness and action.	☒			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements: Scope includes ISWS staff developing a SAFR user guide document with how to navigate the website, as well as suggested applications for flood risk assessment data, developing SAFR training videos – up to 8 short videos to illustrate navigating the SAFR site, as well as outreach to communities with data hosted on SAFR including notification email messages to local current officials and GIS staff. Scope also includes one LOMR workshop per year and one virtual workshop to navigate floodplain managers through using mapping and technical data developed by Risk MAP projects. All workshops will be hosted by ISWS staff.						
Mitigation Planning Technical Assistance	☐	Copies of all technical data provided to local, state, and tribal communities	☐			
		A report detailing the technical assistance provided, including date(s) of technical	☐			

COMS Task	Mark “X” if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark “X” if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
		assistance, type of assistance and local, state, or tribal community stakeholders supported				
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Directly Funded Staffing* <i>(*If Staffing is the only COMS Task to be performed under this SOW, please complete Table 1.2.2 below)</i>	☐	{Insert number of staff} will attend regional mapping meetings hosted by FEMA Regions	☐			
		Maintain {Insert number of staff}; potentially utilize {Insert number of staff} current personnel to support COMS activities	☐			
		Report on Outreach Activities, if applicable	☐			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Pilot Projects	☐	Report on Pilot Activities, if applicable	☐			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements:						
Mentoring	☒	List of existing or potential CTP entities to be mentored	☒	\$25,000		\$25,000

COMS Task	Mark “X” if activity will be done under this SOW	Deliverable	Mark “X” if deliverable will be done under this activity	Project Budget and Leverage by Task		
				(A) FEMA Contribution	(B) Partner Contribution	(A + B) Total Project Cost
		Schedule and explanation of COMS mentoring activities	☐			
		Report detailing COMS mentoring activities provided	☒			
		Participant Surveys completed by mentored individuals that provide feedback on the quality and benefits of the mentor(s) and COMS mentoring activities	☐			
		One - twoCOMS Best Practice write-ups to be shared nationally on the FEMA CTP Collaboration Center	☒			
		Other: {Insert additional details}.	☐			
Detailed Scope Elements: Scope includes participation in the CTP Mentoring Pilot Program, sharing GIS technology solutions like Python scripts and other custom tools, and one – two best practice write ups to be shared on the FEMA CTP Collaboration center. ISWS has been a FEMA CTP since 2004 and has handled many aspects of RiskMAP project development, support for ISWS to share these best practices to enables other CTPs to develop their technical and management practices.						

Table 1.2.2: Percentage of Staff Time Spent on COMS Tasks

This table is only required if Staffing is the only COMS Task to be performed under this SOW (other than the COMS Engagement Plan, which is required). If the CTP is not performing Staffing or is performing multiple activities which include Staffing, this table may not be required. Coordinate with your FEMA POC on any additional applicability.

Task and Activity – Funded Staff				
Section 1: Staff positions <u>funded</u> under	Staff Member 1	Staff Member 2	Staff Member 3	Staff Member 4
COMS Engagement Plan	%	%	%	%
	Brief description of work across staff members			
Strategic Planning for Community Engagement	%	%	%	%
	Brief description of work across staff members			
Meetings and Process Facilitation	%	%	%	%
	Brief description of work across staff members			
Mitigation Support	%	%	%	%
	Brief description of work across staff members			

Communication and Outreach to Communities	%	%	%	%
	Brief description of work across staff members			
{Insert additional activities}				
Total (not to exceed 100 percent per employee)				
Task and Activity – Unfunded Staff (Also reported as Leverage)				
Section 2: Staff positions supporting CTP activities <u>not funded</u> under this	Staff Member 1	Staff Member 2	Staff Member 3	Staff Member 4
Task				
COMS Engagement Plan				
Hazard Mitigation				
Strategic Planning for Community				
Outreach				
Meetings and Process Facilitation				

{Insert additional activities}				
Total (not to exceed 100 percent per employee)				

1.3 – Schedule and Performance

Instructions: Insert deliverables for all activities included in this SOW in the table below. Examples provided in italics. Deliverables can be itemized/scheduled individually or grouped into a single deliverable date. Due dates will be negotiated with the FEMA Regional Project Officer.

Table 1.3.1: COMS Deliverables Schedule

Task and Activity			
SOW Task	Deliverable	Deliverable Due Date	Submitted To
COMS Engagement Plan (required)	COMS Engagement Plan	<i>6 months from award date</i>	<i>FEMA PO</i>
<i>Training and Community Capability Development</i>	Two Risk MAP or NFIP-related workshops or webinars – develop and deliver training SAFR User Guide and training videos Copies of final training materials A list of all participants and completed course evaluations (such as pre- and post-knowledge surveys) after each training course	Before POP Completion December 2022 Before POP Completion	Community and FEMA PO
<i>Strategic Planning for Community Engagement</i>	Update to CTP’s website and other digital platforms as needed	Spring target: April 2023	FEMA PO

Task and Activity			
SOW Task	Deliverable	Deliverable Due Date	Submitted To
<i>Mentoring</i>	Report detailing COMS mentoring activities provided, one - two Best Practice write-ups to be shared on the FEMA CTP Collaboration Center	Before POP completion	FEMA PO

The activities documented in this SOW shall be completed in accordance with Table 1.3.1: COMS Deliverables Schedule. If changes to this schedule are required, the CTP shall coordinate with FEMA and other necessary Mapping Partners in a timely manner. Please also identify to whom the products and/or deliverables associated with each task are to be submitted to (i.e., community, FEMA Regional Project Officer, etc.).

Table 1.3.2: Performance Measures Targets

Note: Insert appropriate measures in table below based on the document “CTP Performance Measures Matrix” and coordination with your FEMA PM. This instructional note should be deleted prior to application submission.

Measure	Target
Evidence of continued maintenance, using non-Federal funds, of the processes/systems to support collection, development, evaluation, dissemination, and communication of flood hazard and risk assessment data and mapping (REQUIRED)	Target should be expressed as either “Achieved” or “Not Achieved” for completing non-federally funded maintenance activities for the CTP agreement. Examples of maintenance activities below: 1. Continued data collection related to changes in flood hazards and development in flood-prone areas 2. Continued upgrades to data collection or mapping capabilities to incorporate new technologies 3. Preparation of multiple-year mapping or data collection plans Maintenance of equipment and supplies, such as hardware, software, licenses, certifications, etc. that are necessary to complete, review, monitor and report on the work

Measure	Target
Earned Value Management (REQUIRED)	Report on SPI and CPI. Must be between 0.92 and 1.08. If it is not, provide information on what is being done to correct the problem.
Timely MIP Management	100% of MIP tasks updated monthly
Hazard Mitigation Planning	Coordinate with State Hazard Mitigation officer or Risk MAP Coordinator to develop or update action(s) and progress annually.
Outreach and Education to the Public	10 training participants.
Website Activity	Update website by posting new data or information within 30 days of new data completion.

PART 2 – REFERENCE INFORMATION

2.1 – Standards

The standards relevant to this SOW are presented in FEMA Policy 204-078-1 [Standards for Flood Risk Analysis and Mapping](http://www.fema.gov/guidelines-and-standards-flood-risk-analysis-and-mapping), Revision 10, dated November 2019 located on FEMA’s website at www.fema.gov/guidelines-and-standards-flood-risk-analysis-and-mapping. Additional information, along with links to Guidance, Technical References, Templates, and other resources that support these standards, may be accessed and/or downloaded from the FEMA Flood Hazard Mapping website at <http://www.fema.gov/guidelines-and-standards-flood-risk-analysis-and-mapping>. FEMA is in the process of updating existing guidance and continues to update guidance and standards on a rolling basis. In the meantime, CTPs may refer to historical documents for assistance. Additionally, CTPs and their sub-awardees must comply with FEMA’s Federal Regulation Chapter 44 of the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR), and the appropriate year CTP Funding Opportunity Announcement and Agreement Articles. CTPs shall also coordinate with their regional office to determine additional standards that should be met. CTPs shall coordinate with the FEMA Regional Project Officer to ensure that technical assistance also complies with regional standards. Additional information may be available in FEMA’s guidance document Risk MAP Guidance for Incorporating Mitigation Planning Technical Assistance and Training into Flood Risk Projects (February 2018) https://www.fema.gov/sites/default/files/2020-02/Incorporating_Mitigation_Planning_Technical_Assistance_into_RM_Projects_Feb_2018.pdf.

2.2 – Use of Contractors

Contractor support may be used for all activities within this SOW, except staffing and mentoring, which must be completed by the CTP. Guidance provided in this part includes, but is not limited to, contract administration and record keeping, notification requirements, review procedures, competition, methods of procurement, and cost and pricing analysis. 2 CFR Part 200 may be viewed online at <http://www.ecfr.gov/cgi-bin/text-idx?SID=cc011f4fb962e68cb0da4bc91e8fbb43&mc=true&node=pt2.1.200&rgn=div5>

Additionally, contractors must not pose a conflict-of-interest issue nor be active in writing the scope of this SOW.

OR

The CTP does not intend to use the services of a contractor for this SOW. No transfer of funds to agencies other than those identified in the approved cooperative agreement application shall be made without prior approval from FEMA. The CTP will identify the name of the CTP contractor for services used as part of this SOW. The CTP shall ensure that the procurement for all contractors used for this COMS Activity complies with the requirements of 2 CFR Part 200.

Guidance provided in this part includes, but is not limited to, contract administration and recordkeeping, notification requirements, review procedures, competition, methods of procurement, and cost and pricing analysis. Additionally, contractors must not pose a conflict-of-interest issue.

2.3 – Reporting and Performance

Financial Reporting: Because funding has been provided to the CTP by FEMA, financial reporting requirements for the CTP will be in accordance with the terms of the Cooperative Agreement Funding Opportunity Announcement, Articles of Agreement, or Award Notice for this SOW. The CTP shall also refer to 2 CFR 200. The CTP shall provide financial reports to the FEMA Regional Project Officer and Assistance Officer in accordance with the terms of the signed Cooperative Agreement for this SOW.

Performance Reporting: Recipients are responsible for providing a signed performance report using the required list of information shown in the Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO) (or and old SF-PPR if you prefer) on a quarterly basis throughout the period of performance, including partial calendar quarters as well as for periods where no grant award activity occurs. The CTP shall refer to 2 CFR Part 200 to obtain minimum requirements for progress reporting. The Project Officer, as needed, may request additional information on progress.

The CTP may meet with FEMA and/or its contractor(s) as frequently as needed to review the progress of the project in addition to the quarterly financial and status submittals. These meetings may alternate between the FEMA Regional Office, the CTP office, and conference calls, as necessary.

The CTP must report performance of the grant in conjunction with the progress reporting. The performance of the CTP is measured by Table 1.3.2 Performance Measure Targets. If you are completing a COMS project in conjunction with a Flood Risk Project MAS, then you may use the measures outlined in that MAS for your SF-PPP performance criteria.

Quantitative Targets for performance measures will be defined using the CTP Performance Measures Menu in conjunction with your FEMA PM and amended to the MAS.

Earned Value Data Entry:

The CTP is required to report on the earned value of projects that are in the MIP monthly and must give explanations for variances outside of the tolerance defined above. The FEMA Regional Offices must implement a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) when a CTP partner is outside of the tolerance. A CAP must define the reason for the variance and the intended resolution. FEMA Regional Offices must coordinate with FEMA Headquarters when CAPs are developed.

Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies (COMS) SOW/Program Management (PM) SOW tasks are now tracked in the MIP. Cost and schedule performance measures are defined in this SOW. These measures will be used to monitor partner performance and to determine future funding eligibility. Earned Value data entry involves updating cost, schedule, and performance (physical percent complete) in the MIP by the CTP each month for each assigned task. The CTP may contact the Region to obtain additional guidance (as needed) for updating COMS/PM efforts in the MIP.

2.4 – Privacy and Protection of Personally Identifiable Information

Your organizational access to the MIP signifies that you have access to Personally Identifiable Information (PII). As such, please ensure each user is meeting the requirements with the new Risk Analysis Management Access Request (RAMSAR) process, including:

- Signed and executed Information Sharing Access Agreement (ISAA) for the CTP organization
- RAMSAR form for every CTP staff and CTP contractor user that needs access to the Risk Analysis Management (RAM) System, which also acknowledges review of the Rules of Behavior

Please contact your FEMA Project Officer for more information.

2.5 – Available COMS Scope Activities

The activities outlined in this SOW will be completed as specified in the Cooperative Agreement Funding Opportunity Announcement, Award Notice, and/or Articles of Agreement. The SOW may be terminated at the option of FEMA or the CTP in accordance with the provisions of the Partnership Agreement. If the SOW is terminated, all products produced to date must be returned and remaining funds, provided by FEMA for this SOW, from uncompleted activities will be returned to FEMA.

The objective of the Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies (COMS) activity documented in this Statement of Work (SOW) is to recognize and enhance activities undertaken by Cooperating Technical Partners (CTPs) that create an environment where communities:

- Understand their flood risk and the importance of addressing that risk;
- Are more willing to engage with the Mapping Partner and FEMA to analyze their risks;
- Are better primed to take action to reduce their risk, based on that analysis.

Specifically, tasks funded under this SOW support and enhance COMS activities. All processes and deliverables shall be completed in accordance with FEMA's [Guidelines and Standards for Flood Risk Analysis and Mapping](https://www.fema.gov/guidelines-and-standards-flood-risk-analysis-and-mapping), Revision 11, dated December 2020 located on FEMA's website at www.fema.gov/guidelines-and-standards-flood-risk-analysis-and-mapping. These guidelines and standards define the specific implementation of the statutory and regulatory requirements for National Flood Insurance Program (NFIP) flood risk projects and address the performance of related Risk Mapping, Assessment, and Planning (Risk MAP) activities.

COMS tasks cannot result in the production of a Flood Insurance Rate Map (FIRM). The activity/activities that could be accomplished under the COMS SOW are as follows:

- **COMS Engagement Plan (Required)**
- **Strategic Planning for Community Engagement**
- **Meetings and Process Facilitation**
- **Mitigation Support**
- **Communication and Outreach to Communities**
- **Training and Community Capability Development**
- **Mitigation Planning Technical Assistance**
- **Pilot Projects**
- **Internal Partner Support Activities:**
- **Mentoring**
- **Staffing**

Contractor support may be used for all activities except staffing and mentoring, which must be completed by the CTP.

COMS Engagement Plan (Required)

Intent: Document prepared by recipients and used by Regional Offices in support of Risk MAP Multi-year Planning. This plan should identify the overarching approach to community engagement, that will then be implemented on a project-by-project basis. This plan must:

1. Document the capabilities and accomplishments of the partner related to Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies. For example, summarize the partner's capabilities to do community outreach and provide some examples of successful community outreach efforts. And/or provide an overview of the partners strategic approach to community engagement and critical factors in successfully engaging communities in reducing their risk.
2. Explain the recipient's vision for implementing or participating in Risk MAP, specifically describing how the partner's activities advance the vision, goals and objectives of Risk MAP for encouraging communities to take action to mitigate risk.
3. Include examples or updates from previous years' activities (if applicable).
4. Provide recommendations to FEMA regarding action and outreach potential for future Risk MAP projects within the State, regional or local area.

Recipients that are also completing activities under the PM SOW may combine Business Plan and the COMS Engagement Plan for these two SOWs into a comprehensive Business Plan that includes the required elements for both the PM SOW Business Plan and the COMS SOW Engagement Plan. Recipients must work with their FEMA Regional Office for additional details and requirements of Business/Engagement Plans, including due dates, for the State and/or Local Business Plans.

ALTERNATE LANGUAGE IF CTP HAS BOTH COMS AND PM SOWS

COMS Engagement Plan

Intent: Combined the Business Plan requirements of the PM and COMS awards into a single deliverable, with approval from the FEMA Regional Project Officer.

Strategic Planning for Community Outreach and Engagement

Intent: The CTP will strategically prepare for engagement with communities and stakeholders, to strengthen and focus project discussions towards taking mitigation action to reduce natural hazard risk. This work can include the development of plans, to create a framework for action throughout a project, and/or can also include outreach activities with the community, to facilitate its forwarding progress in reducing risk.

There are many ways to encourage natural hazard reduction or mitigation:

- Ensure the community understands and accepts its flood risk

- Educate the community about how mitigation can help their community in a way that is meaningful to them
- Provide technical assistance to help identify what mitigation makes sense
- Ensure the right stakeholders (community officials, local influencers, regional and state partners, etc.) are involved in the work, so that the decision-making required for mitigation action can be achieved.
- Understand the community's other key concerns that might impact their interest and capacity and inform how best to engage with them.

Note: Communication and outreach activities described in this task are meant to be supplemental or complementary efforts to those identified in the Flood Risk Project Mapping Activity Statement (MAS). CTPs and the FEMA Region are responsible for confirming no duplication of effort in other awards (grants, cooperative agreements, interagency agreements and contracts).

Examples of plans and activities that could inform the partners' work and build knowledge of and relationships with communities:

Awareness and Action Strategy – Develop a regional approach to better understand communities' needs and priorities by conducting research on demographics, community communications practices and preferences, evaluation of local plans and initiatives, identification of local decision-makers and potential advocates, mitigation history and potential roadblocks, existing relationships with state and federal agencies, etc.

Watershed and Community Assessment and Mitigation Action Plan – Assess a watershed and high priority communities to understand their mitigation priorities and their existing relationships with FEMA and other federal agencies to inform future outreach. The assessment may include local planners, floodplain administrators, elected officials, community leaders, local levee/dam/coastal leadership, business owners, residents, participants from other local departments such as public works, and others, based on local needs.

Relationship Management Plan – Identify how to establish and/or build relationships between FEMA, the partner, and local stakeholders.

Community Prioritization – Prioritize the action potential, action readiness, or need of communities within a watershed to inform project scoping and planning.

Integration Planning – Help state, federal, and local partners coordinate efforts that move communities towards reducing flood risk. For example, convening a variety of stakeholders (who might have diverse goals) and providing tools and knowledge to conduct joint mitigation planning in a watershed.

The CTP will coordinate with their Regional Project Officer to ensure up to date products and templates are used and new products are coordinated and fully reviewed prior to dissemination.

Meetings and Process Facilitation (if needed)

Intent: The CTP will hold meetings and facilitate the decision-making processes. Meeting activities are only allowable if they are not funded under an award for a specific project area

outlined in a Flood Risk Project MAS, or the CTP must provide additional scope to clarify the difference between the funding under the COMS SOW and the MAS for the specific flood risk project. The following potential activities included in this task are listed below:

Process Facilitation – Support for implementation of the strategic planning efforts may include identifying and supporting key community priorities and key influencers; support community identification of mitigation opportunities; gap analysis of community requirements for mitigation implementation; ongoing relationship management; monitoring, evaluation, and update.

The Mapping Partner shall notify FEMA and all applicable parties of all meetings with community officials at least 3 to 6 weeks prior to the meeting (with as much notice as possible). FEMA and/or its contractor(s) may or may not attend the community meetings.

Mitigation Support

Intent: The CTP will leverage Risk MAP data, analyses, products, and/or processes to support communities to advance mitigation actions. Funds cannot be used to update all or part of a Hazard Mitigation Plan but may be used to integrate hazard mitigation concepts into community plans and regulations.

The CTP shall work in close coordination with state and local Emergency Management Offices throughout the life cycle of a Risk MAP project to collect and quantify Actions Identified and Actions Advanced as part of a project specific MAS. Additionally, Actions should be collected throughout the period of performance of this grant for any projects even after the close out of a Risk MAP project. This activity is used to provide for the coordinated effort with local emergency management to communicate with communities outside of the life cycle of the Risk MAP project, extending beyond completion of the project for all watersheds that fall within the Period of Performance of this SOW.

Potential activities include:

Action Identified – Support for communities to identify mitigation opportunities and/or select alternatives through the provision of data and/or analysis. Data is considered new data or aggregation of existing data that is delivered and disseminated in formats readily consumed by the end user. Analysis (i.e., risk assessments; social vulnerability analysis; triple bottom line analysis; and feasibility assessments) may be performed to help identify solutions to identified problems and/or develop requirements for project solutions. There also is an opportunity to help the community understand its geographic location in the larger watershed and how the topography of the watershed should be considered in the selection of mitigation projects, given that one community's effort can have an impact downstream or upstream. Support could also include helping communities understand what capacity they need to undertake a project, how to organize their approach to project planning, how to engage the appropriate stakeholders to gain consensus around project options, and how to pursue funding sources to support the project.

Action Advanced – Support for communities to advance mitigation opportunities including scoping/design; budgeting; obtaining funding; project planning; technical support for zoning, code, and/or ordinance development. Support can also include helping communities navigate jurisdictional boundaries, political challenges related to gaining consensus and funding, support in navigating Federal and State regulations and program requirements, identifying potential project partners, and educating the public about the benefit of the mitigation and any potential impacts that might occur during implementation.

Evaluation and Valuation – Support provided to the community to evaluate and demonstrate the value of the mitigation investment, including calculating economic, environmental and/or social benefits as well as avoided losses from natural hazard events.

Other – Other activities as negotiated with the FEMA Region.

Communication and Outreach to Communities

Intent: The CTP will develop, promote and deliver resources and products to communities for risk awareness and mitigation action, such as developing messages and products to implement strategic outreach campaigns. Activities include:

Materials Development & Dissemination to Educate Communities – Develop and disseminate messages and materials that increase community understanding and awareness of both flood and other natural hazards and the support project work that is developing an updated assessment of community risk. Materials could include: plain language explanations of how flood risk is assessed and displayed in a regulatory product; how flood risk data can be used to inform community planning, why community feedback is critical to a flood risk project, updated website content, etc.

Materials Development to Help Community Officials in Their Own Outreach – Sample media materials to help promote a public meeting or explain project status, social media content and imagery for community officials to use , sample website copy, etc.

Other – Other activities as negotiated with the FEMA Region.

Training and Community Capability Development

Intent: Develop and provide training to State and Local Officials throughout the course of a flood risk project (at the discretion of the Regional Office) that promotes awareness and mitigation action.

The CTP must ensure, and must provide documentation when requested by FEMA, that activities funded through this SOW do not replace activities funded under other federal grant programs, such as Hazard Mitigation Planning or Floodplain Management grant programs.

The recipient must identify if the training will be conducted by in-house staff or through contracted services.

Training can be provided at any time during a Risk MAP project, and it may be beneficial to include a series of training activities over the course of a flood risk project. The CTP will coordinate and/or administer training for communities and/or individual groups regarding. The CTP will:

- Determine target audience
- Advertise to, and confirm training participants
- Determine training facility
- Deliver training
- Conduct training evaluations
- Follow-up with participants on unresolved issues

Activities may include planning, developing, and delivering trainings or direct support in the areas of:

Benefit Cost Analysis (BCA) – Support local, state, and tribal communities to identify, capture, and document the necessary data to run a BCA as well as understand how to run the FEMA approved BCA model. Funds cannot be used to run a benefit cost analysis.

Building Science – Support local, state, and tribal communities in the understanding of construction issues and opportunities in the identified natural hazard and risk areas.

Community Capability Development – Support building community capability to sponsor and implement mitigation actions through activities such as: capability assessment; gap analysis; and process, change, and project management.

Community Rating System (CRS) – How to integrate CRS elements into mitigation plans and floodplain ordinances (public information, mapping and regulation, flood damage reduction, warning, and response).

Community Planning – Support local, state, and tribal communities in the consideration of natural hazards in all relevant areas of community planning, i.e., comprehensive plans, capital improvement plans, stormwater management, etc.

Grant Application Development – Support local, state, and tribal jurisdictions in the development of scopes of work, schedules, and budgets for a successful mitigation activity grant application. Funds may not be used to develop, submit, or execute a grant proposal on behalf of a state, tribe, or local jurisdiction.

Mitigation Planning Technical Assistance – Support local, state, and tribal communities by the creation and dissemination of training and technical assistance for achieving mitigation actions. This task cannot fund an activity that is already funded through another federal grant (including the PM SOW) and should not duplicate assistance available to any community engaged in a Risk MAP Project or a pre- or post-disaster grant funded through the Hazard Mitigation Assistance program. Training can be provided at any time during the Risk MAP project. It may be desired to include a series of training activities over the course of a flood risk project.

Risk Assessment – Support local, state, and tribal communities in the assessment of relative risk for decision support, including HAZUS or other methods. Provide technical assistance on how to use a risk assessment tool.

Risk MAP Data Availability and Tools – Support building community capability to use and understand the regulatory and flood risk components and tools of a Risk MAP project including Flood Risk Products.

Other – Other activities as negotiated with the FEMA Region.

Mitigation Planning Technical Assistance

Intent: Encourage hazard mitigation plan implementation and advance community hazard mitigation actions through technical assistance that supports the Mitigation Planning Process and Risk MAP projects.

Develop and disseminate products and materials to support local, state, and tribal jurisdictions to develop,

evaluate, update, and implement their mitigation plans and strategies. Technical Assistance provided through Risk MAP should focus on building a community's capability to plan for and reduce risk. Technical Assistance should encourage hazard mitigation plan implementation and advance community hazard mitigation actions through the Mitigation Planning Process in the form of administration, Technical Assistance for specific planning requirements, and resources for improved planning. The following steps are emphasized:

- Incorporating new flood hazard and risk information.
- Updating and refining mitigation strategies especially as related to new flood hazard/risk information.
- Training mitigation planning teams.
- Incorporating mitigation concepts into existing community plans, programs, and policies.

This task may not be used to fund the creation or update of a Hazard Mitigation Plan. This task cannot fund an activity that is already funded through another federal grant (including the PM SOW) and should not duplicate assistance available to any community engaged in a Risk MAP project or an HMA planning or project grant, including planning-related activities HMA grants.

CTP must ensure that technical assistance activities proposed in the COMS SOW are focused on support related to community engagement, risk communication and identifying and/or advancing mitigation action, and that these activities are not duplicated in the Program Management SOW.

Staffing

Intent: Provide staff to support Risk MAP COMS activities.

Mentoring

Intent: Share CTP program experience and related information with peer participants regarding best practices and process improvements related to COMS activities.

COMS Pilot Projects

Intent: *(As defined by and negotiated with the FEMA Regional Office and approved in coordination with FEMA HQ)*

AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE SIGNATURES

Each party has caused this SOW to be executed by its duly authorized representative.



08/09/2021

Glenn Heistand
Project Manager
Illinois State Water Survey

Date

John Wethington
Regional Project Officer
Federal Emergency Management Agency, Region 5

Date

Julia McCarthy
Risk Analysis Branch Chief
Federal Emergency Management Agency, Region 5

Date

Mary Beth Caruso
Mitigation Division Director
Federal Emergency Management Agency, Region 5

Date